

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

It's time to turn the TV off!



Learning Outcome

Describe situations in spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How do you feel about violence on television?
- Were you allowed to watch anything you wanted on TV when you were a child? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about TV shows and films.
- I can say and use could've and would've.
- I can use different tones to stress, contrast or emphasize information.

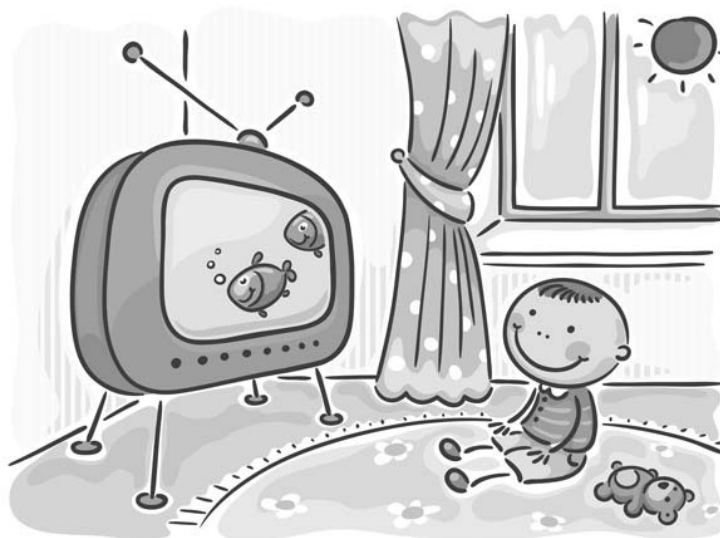




Let's Explore!

Media violence and **aggressive*** behavior is well documented.

* When behavior is "aggressive", it is confrontational.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Most kids in the US could have spent up to five hours in front of the television today. If there are no parent controls on the TV they could've been watching anything! What they see can have a strong effect on them. It's not surprising that more and more parents are becoming concerned about what their children watch. Parents of younger children feel that children's programs are nothing more than commercials for toys and other products. They feel that the first priority of cartoons and kids' shows should've been to educate, not to sell merchandise.

Other parents are concerned about the amount of violence on television. It's estimated that by the time the average child left elementary school, he or she would've witnessed 8,000 murders and over 100,000 other acts of violence. By the time that a child is 18 years of age; he or she might've witnessed 200,000 acts of violence, including 40,000 murders. The connection between media violence and aggressive behavior in real life is well documented. A paper by the American Psychiatric Association on media violence has declared that to argue against that connection is like arguing against gravity. So, parents who think that much content should've been reserved for late night television are right. They might've also realized that violence is visible in newscasts as well and saved that for late night viewing. Could it be time to unplug the set altogether?





Let's Practice!

Watch out! Your children might have been watching improper content on TV.

Instructions: Draw a line to match the definitions in Column A with the words in Column B. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. control on TV content that children watch
2. special attention you give to something
3. commercialized objects that appear on TV
4. to calculate approximately
5. to see or know by personal experience

COLUMN B

- a. priority
- b. merchandise
- c. witness
- d. parent control
- e. to estimate



Let's Practice!

Let's learn how to stress or emphasize information when speaking.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. effect / . / can / on / What / see / have / children / them / a / strong

2. are / becoming / children / that / parents / about / their / what / not / surprising / concerned / It's

3. concerned / of / . / Other / about / amount / are / parents / violence / on / television / the





Extension Activity

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self Assessment. Watch an old TV show.

- Go online or to the library to find an old TV from 'The Golden Age of Television'.
- Watch an episode of the show and take notes.
- Describe how the people, places, family, activities and the way things look are different than they are today.
- Now write 200 words saying what characters would've done in the past compared to what they could've done in a current TV show.
- Read your ideas to a partner being careful to enunciate the reductions.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I watch an old TV show episode and make notes answering wh- questions.

☐ ☐

I write about the old TV shows saying what they would've done then.

☐ ☐

I comment on what they could've done now if the show were on today.

☐ ☐

I read my ideas to a partner, pronouncing could've/would've reductions correctly.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- parent control** (noun): a feature of some electronic equipment like television or Internet that allows parents to limit the viewing access of their children
e.g. If there is no parent controls on the TV they could've been watching anything!
- visible** (adjective): Example: They feel that the first priority of cartoons and kids' shows should've been to educate, not to sell merchandise.
Violence is visible in newscasts as well.
- merchandise** (noun): goods that are bought or sold; goods that are for sale in a shop/store
e.g. The first priority of cartoons and kids' shows should've been to educate, not to sell merchandise.
- to estimate** (verb): to guess or calculate the cost, size, value, etc. of something
e.g. It's estimated that by the time the average child left elementary school, he or she would've witnessed 8,000 murders.
- to witness** (verb): to see something happen
e.g. By the time that child is 18 years of age; he or she might've witnessed 200,000 acts of violence.
- gravity** (noun): the force that attracts objects in space towards each other, and that on the earth pulls them towards the centre of the planet, so that things fall to the ground when they are dropped
e.g. A paper by the American Psychiatric Association on media violence has declared that to argue against that connection is like arguing against gravity.
- priority** (noun): something that is very important and must be dealt with before other things
e.g. They feel that the first priority of cartoons and kids' shows should've been to educate, not to sell merchandise.





Learning Points

Reduction of Have in Past Modals and in Auxiliary Verbs

When you use auxiliary verbs like *have*, it is common to reduce it in speaking.

In English, not every word or syllable is fully pronounced.

When you reduce the sound of *have* it sounds like **uv** or **iv**.

Read each sentence in its full form:

- Most kids in the U.S. **could have** spent up to five hours in front of the television today.
- If there are no parent controls on the TV they **could have** been watching anything!
- They feel that the first priority of cartoons and kids' shows **should have** been to educate, not to sell merchandise.
- He or she **would have** witnessed 8,000 murders and over 100,000 other acts of violence.
- By the time that child is 18 years of age, he or she **might have** witnessed 200,000 acts of violence.
- So, parents who think that much content **should have** been reserved for late night television are right.
- They **might have** also realized that violence is visible in newscasts.

Now read them and reduce the pronunciation of the auxiliary verb *have*:

- Most kids in the US **could've** spent up to five hours in front of the television today.
could_uv
- They feel that the first priority of cartoons and kids' shows **should've** been to educate, not to sell merchandise. **should_uv**
- He or she **would've** witnessed 8,000 murders and over 100,000 other acts of violence.
would_uv
- By the time that child is 18 years of age; he or she **might've** witnessed 200,000 acts of violence. **might_uv**
- So, parents who think that much content **should've** been reserved for late night television are right. **should_uv**
- They **might've** also realized that violence is visible in newscasts. **might_uv**





Learning Points

Tonic, Contrastive, Emphatic and New Information Stress

There are various types of stress used when speaking English. Sentence stress gives English its **rhythm** or "beat".

Tonic stress refers to the syllable in a word which receives the most stress in an intonation unit.

For example:

- *If there are no parent **controls** on the TV/ they could've been watching **anything**!*
- *What they **see**/ can have a strong effect on them.*
- *Could it be **time**/ to unplug the set altogether?*

When you want to point out the difference between one point and another, you use **contrastive stress**.

For example:

- **Other** parents are concerned about the amount of violence on television.
- The connection between **media violence** and **aggressive behavior** in real life is well documented.
- A paper by the American Psychiatric Association on media violence has declared that **to argue against** that connection is **like arguing against** gravity.

To emphasize a word, you can change the stress from the principal word or phrase to another content word or phrase. By choosing a word other than the one you normally stress, you put emphasis on the new one.

For example:

- *It's not surprising that **more and more** parents are becoming concerned about **what** their children watch.*
- Parents of **younger** children feel that children's programs are nothing more than commercials for toys and other products.
- They feel that the first priority of cartoons and kids' shows should've been to educate, **not** to sell merchandise.

